was also proposed, with 54 Infantry Division being nominated for this role, but the idea was not implemented due to a paucity of resources.



Indian Army soldiers undertake training at the Commando Training School Belgaum, Karnataka, 29 December 1980. (Sondeep Shankar/Getty Images)

To support the offensive tasks, the Army inducted new weapons to include T-72 tanks, BMP-1 and BMP-2 IFVs, anti-tank missiles, surface-to-air missiles and 155mm FH-77B towed howitzers as the early 1980s saw the biggest expansion of the Indian Army since 1947, with the armoured corps alone raising 28 new armoured regiments (5, 6, 10–13, 40–44, 46–49, 73–75, 81–90). In 1981, the artillery adopted the 130mm M-46 *Catapult* self-propelled gun, which used the Soviet 130mm M-46 field gun mounted on a lengthened *Vijayanta* tank hull.

By 1984 the Indian Army was composed of two armoured divisions (1 and 31), one mechanized division (33), 16 infantry divisions (3, 4, 7, 9, 10, 11, 12, 15, 16, 19, 22, 23, 25, 26, 39 and 54), ten mountain divisions (2, 5, 6, 8, 17, 20, 21, 27, 28 and 57), four RAPID divisions (14, 18, 24 and 36), five independent armoured brigades (3, 6, 14, 16 and 23), 14 independent artillery brigades, one independent infantry brigade (75) and one parachute brigade (50).